

product categories with 15 variants in total. The categories include tubes and bulbs, table-top decorative products, fittings for modern offices, fittings for the hospitality industry and fittings for outdoor applications.

Livingston establishes Indian operations

Already recognised as Europe's leading test and measurement rental supplier, providing companies with cutting-edge test equipment without calling for heavy capital expenditure, Livingston has now entered the emerging Indian market by opening an office in Gurgaon.

According to Philippe Suel, international development director of Livingston Group's test division, "Engineers must have access to the latest test hardware, but finding the funds to purchase this is often difficult. By following the rental model advocated by Livingston, large upfront payments are avoided and equipment can be treated as an operational expense that can be stopped whenever it is no longer being utilised."

Wynn Telecom plans handset manufacturing in HP

Wynn Telecom, a new venture of the SAR Group, will soon join the league of mobile handset manufacturers in India. With an investment of Rs 2.7 billion, the company is now in the process of setting up a plant in Himachal Pradesh to start manufacturing mobile handsets in the country.

"The unit is expected to get operational by the end of 2011 and will have a production capacity of one million handsets a month," said Arvind Vohra, co-founder and managing director, Wynn Telecom.

Wynn had recently rolled out seven models of its 'Wynncom' brand of mobile handsets in Gujarat. It now hopes to add more handsets, including touchscreen phones, to its kitty.

Tata DoCoMo to offer Nokia Ovi tools

Nokia India has partnered with Tata DOCOMO, the GSM brand of Tata

Teleservices, to offer Nokia Ovi Life Tools to all Tata DOCOMO subscribers. Nokia Ovi Life Tools are services specifically created for the emerging markets to plug information gaps in the areas of agriculture, education and entertainment.

Both partners will work together to deliver news alerts in the fields of agriculture and education on schemes and other relevant information directly to thousands of users of this service.

Schneider globalises innovation challenge

Schneider Electric, a global player in energy management, has announced the sixth edition of *Innovation Challenge*—a search by the company to recognise the smartest engineering brains. This year, it has opened this competition to engineering colleges from 15 Asian countries also.

Innovation Challenge is a contest for undergraduate engineering students, with different themes proposed every year. This year's theme is energy-efficient buildings. The contest invites students to display creativity and simplicity in solutions to the given problem, and in doing so, compete with the best engineering minds across countries. It also seeks to build commitment to research and development and a feel for the real issues confronting organisations.

For more information on *Innovation Challenge 2010*, log into www.schneider-electric.co.in/sites/india/en/group/ic/ic.page

Opportunities in strategic electronics explored at SES 2010

With active participation by top brass of defence forces and M.M. Pallam Raju, minister of state for defence, as well as co-sponsorship by Department of IT, government of India, ELCINA Electronic Industries Association of India, recently organised the *Strategic Electronics Summit* at Indian Institute of Science, Bengaluru.

The event was supported by lead-

ing public and private organisations including Bharat Electronics, C-DOT, Electronics Corporation of India, Tata Power and National Instruments. There were over 60 participating companies and 150 delegates at the event with keen interest in strategic electronics sector. The objective of the event was to highlight the importance and opportunities in strategic electronics and to bring the defence and aerospace sectors within the reach of a large number of Indian companies, especially small and medium enterprises.

Renesas to acquire Nokia's wireless modem business

Renesas Electronics and Nokia have formed a strategic business alliance to develop modem technologies for HSPA+/LTE (Evolved High-Speed Packet Access/Long-Term Evolution) and its evolution. As part of this alliance, Renesas Electronics will acquire Nokia's wireless modem business for approximately \$200 million. The alliance is expected to be enhanced by long-term joint research cooperation on future radio technologies.

The planned transfer of Nokia's wireless modem business enables Renesas Electronics to maximise the value of Nokia's technology assets and engineering expertise in delivering advanced mobile platform solutions to the market by combining them with Renesas Electronics' multimedia processing and RF technologies.

Sharp to enter e-book reader business

Japanese electronics maker Sharp is planning to enter the hot but increasingly crowded e-book reader market later this year with a device that will allow users to watch video as well as listen to audio content. The company is reportedly in launch talks with Verizon Wireless. The device, that will first hit the Japanese stores, will read files in a new version of XMDF (eXtending Mobile Document Format)—a format developed by Sharp.